He said, "Oh no. In Germany, we consider science fiction an American literary form and it wouldn't sound right without American names."

I saw his point. If you were going to write a sword-play historical romance, Monsieur du Vallon de Bracieux de Pierrefonds sounds much better than Mr. Joe Green.

22

Gertrude had her turn at a sort of vacation over the weekend of August 16-17. She went off on an auto trip with two girls whom we had met at Birchtoft two years before. They went to Annisquam for the Saturday and Sunday, and they, too, saw and heard the staff do my version of Kiss Me, Kate.

She told me, after she returned, that they had sat in front of two middle-aged women, one of whom excitedly said to the other at the conclusion of the show, "Wasn't it wonderful?"

And the second one said, "The music isn't so much, but the words were great!"

(Were you listening, Cole?)

After Gertrude returned, Sam Merwin called. He was in Concord, Massachusetts, temporarily, and wanted to see me. I visited him on August 19 and spent two hours with him. He apologized again for not taking "Grow Old with Me," and I waved it away.

And the next day, David celebrated his first birthday.

2 3

I might have gone to the Breadloaf Writers Conference this year, but I had spent a week at Annisquam, and enough was enough.

Besides, I had to spend the last week in August at a Gordon Research Conference. There are weeks and weeks of this in New Hampshire every summer, each week devoted to a different subject. The reason I had to attend was that this week's session was devoted to cancer, and Henry Lemon was going to talk there. I drove to New Hampshire on August 25, 1952, and was assigned to a room with Pat McGrady, a science writer.

He warned me of his snoring. "Wake me up if I snore," he said.